Need to use a proper script for Samskritam

Even though Bhagavan understands all languages, the power of our Bharatiya languages cannot be matched in expressing our cultural values especially when rising to the plane of conversing with Bhagavan. Of them, the Samskrita bhasha is special in that it is pan-Bharatiya. Hence our scriptures, anushthana paddhati-s and a lot of bhakti sahitya texts are in Samskrita only.

We know that in Samskritam, especially for anushthanam, sound/pronunciation is important. Therefore one should write and read sankalpa shloka-s etc for anushthanam in an appropriate script which is capable of distinguishing all the sounds of Samskritam.

Now the Latin (English) script was evolved for other languages, and we all know the difficulty of correlating spelling and pronunciation even in English. Further, more letters are required to write Samskritam than English as there are more sounds in it. However, since Latin script is widely known, scholars felt it useful to create a Latin-based transliteration system for Samskritam.

In such a system, Latin letters which may be casually applied to different sounds need to be differentiated. For instance in Rama the first or second "a" may denote a long sound. This is differentiated as Rāma or Ramā. Similarly, other marks called diacritics are used to differentiate sounds as in aā iī uū rṛṝ lḷḹ mṃ hḥ nṅñṇ tṭ dḍ sśṣ. Aspirated (mahāprāna) sounds are denoted with an additional h as in k/kh, g/gh, c/ch, j/jh, ṭ/ṭh, ḍ/ḍh, t/th, d/dh, p/ph, b/bh.

However, a system is useful only if followed correctly. If diacritics or added h-s are ignored and we do not read with the intended pronunciation, then the transliteration is no longer useful for its intended purpose. It is very easy to ignore diacritics as they are not in daily use. It would then have altogether been better to use a script which actually has different symbols for the sounds.

Therefore **it is strongly recommended to learn a Bharatiya script** like Devanagari, Grantha, Telugu, Kannada etc **which has clearly different letters to denote the various sounds**. Our documents are published in many such scripts.

However, with a view to help people who are not able to immediately learn such scripts, we are now publishing documents in Latin transliteration as well as per the system called International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration (IAST). For the above reasons, people should use these as a temporary measure till they learn a Bharatiya script.

The Samskrita varnamala in IAST is given below with Devanagari equivalents:

a अ, ā आ, i इ, ī ई, u उ, ū ऊ, ṛ ऋ, ṝ ॠ, ḷ ऌ, ḹ ॡ

e ए, ai ऐ, o ओ, au औ, aṃ अं, aḥ अः

ka क, kha ख, ga ग, gha घ, ṇa ङ

ca च, cha छ, ja ज, jha झ, ña ञ

ṭa ट, ṭha ठ, ḍa ड, ḍha ढ, ṇa ण

ta त, tha थ, da द, dha ध, na न

pa प, pha फ, ba ब, bha भ, ma म

ya य, ra र, la ल, va व, śa श, ṣa ष, sa स, ha ह

-o-

hara hara śaṅkara oṃ jaya jaya śaṅkara








śrī-vedavyāsāya namaḥ

śrīmad-ādya-śaṅkara-bhagavatpāda-paramparāgata-mūlāmnāya-sarvajña-pīṭham
śrī-kāñcī-kāmakoṭi-pīṭham
jagadguru-śrī-śaṅkarācārya-svāmi-śrīmaṭha-saṃsthānam

||tulā-snāna-vidhiḥ||

The procedure for Tula Snanam

The Significance of Tula Snanam

☞ The Greatness of Kaveri

'Tula Snanam' refers to the act of bathing in the river Kaveri during the Tula month (Tamil Aippasi). Performing this ritual bestows immense punya. Throughout this entire month, all sacred waters — including those of the river Ganga — reside within the river Kaveri.

Tula Snanam is performed on the days when Tula month exists during the Arunodaya (four nadika-s before sunrise). Bathing daily in the Kaveri during this month grants a person the four purusharthas: Dharma, Artha, Kama, and Moksha. Furthermore, dana dharma activities performed on the banks of the Kaveri during this month yield punya equivalent to performing the same acts on the banks of the river Ganga.

The dip of the lame devotee (Mudavan Muzhukku)

There is a special observance associated with Tula Snanam that takes place on the first day after the main Tula snana period (usually the first day of the Vrishchika month). This is known as ”Mudavan Muzhukku” or the dip of the lame devotee.

The story goes that a man named Natha Sarma who was lame (unable to walk), and his wife Anavidyambika, having heard of the great significance of Tula Snanam, traveled a long distance to reach Mayuram (Mayiladuthurai). Due to the disability, they arrived only as the month of Tula was coming to an end. Upon realizing that the prescribed period for Tula Snanam had already passed, they were deeply disappointed.

As they prayed to the Lord in their sorrow, Bhagavan Shiva appeared in their dreams and instructed them to bathe the following morning (the first day of the Vrishchika month), assuring them that they would receive the punya of snana during the entire Tula month. Therefore, for those who are unable to bathe throughout the entire month of Tula, taking a ritual bath on the day of ’Mudavan Muzhukku’ will yield the same merit.

ācamanam| śuklāmbaradharaṃ + śāntaye| prāṇāyāmaḥ|

mamopāttasamastaduritakṣayadvārā śrīparameśvaraprītyarthaṃ

tadeva lagnaṃ sudinaṃ tadeva tārābalaṃ candrabalaṃ tadeva|
vidyābalaṃ daivabalaṃ tadeva lakṣmīpateḥ aṅghriyugaṃ smarāmi||

apavitraḥ pavitro vā sarvāvasthāṃ gato’pi vā|
yaḥ smaret puṇḍarīkākṣaṃ sa bāhyābhyantaraḥ śuciḥ||

mānasaṃ vācikaṃ pāpaṃ karmaṇā samupārjitam|
śrīrāma-smaraṇenaiva vyapohati na saṃśayaḥ||

śrī rāma rāma rāma

tithirviṣṇuḥ tathā vāraḥ nakṣatraṃ viṣṇureva ca|
yogaśca karaṇaṃ caiva sarvaṃ viṣṇumayaṃ jagat||

śrīgovinda govinda govinda|

mamopātta-samasta-durita-kṣaya-dvārā śrīparameśvara-prītyarthaṃ bhagavataḥ nārāyaṇasya parameśvarasya acintyayā aparimitayā śaktyā bhriyamāṇasya mahājalaughasya madhye paribhramatām aneka-koṭi-brahmāṇḍānām ekatame caturdaśa-bhuvanāntargate bhū-maṇḍale sapta-dvīpa-madhye jambū-dvīpe nava-varṣa-madhye bhārata-varṣe nava-khaṇḍa-madhye bharata-khaṇḍe himācala-kailāsa-vindhyācalādi-aneka-puṇya-śaila-śikharite daṇḍakāraṇya-vindhyāraṇya-vedāraṇyādi-aneka-puṇyāraṇya-vanaśrī-bhāsvare asmin bhārata-deśe pravahantīnāṃ priyāḥ mātara iva payasā prajāḥ puṣṇatīnāṃ nadīnām anyatamāyāṃ **kāverī-nāmnyām**

1. karṇāṭakeṣu kôḍagu-iti-khyāta-malayācala-saṃjñaka-sahyādri-pradeśe sambhūtāyāṃ, draviḍeṣu śvetāraṇya-kṣetra-samīpe kāverī-pattanākhye puṇya-sthale samudraṃ prāpnuvatyām,

2. sākṣād viṣṇu-māyā-rūpiṇyāṃ, caturmukhasya kanyātvena sthitāyāṃ, tadanugrahāt kavera-nāmno rājñaḥ putrītvaṃ prāptāyāṃ, manuṣya-rūpeṇa lopāmudrā-nāmnā agastya-patnītvaṃ gatāyāṃ, tīrtha-rūpeṇa tat-kamaṇḍalu-sthitāyāṃ,

3. bhagavatā nārāyaṇenaiva dakṣiṇa-gaṅgātvena uktvā,

   tri-rātraṃ jāhnavī-tīre pañca-rātraṃ tu yāmune|
   sadyaḥ punāti kāverī pāpam ā-maraṇāntikam||

   iti ca praśastāyām, bhagavatā maheśvareṇa “ahaṃ tava utpatti-sthāna-prabhṛti samudra-saṅgama-paryantam ubhayoḥ kūlayoḥ vatsyāmi” iti anugṛhītāyām,

4. tulā-saṅkramaṇa-puṇya-kāle bhagavatā gaṇeśena kāka-rūpa-dhareṇa agastya-kamaṇḍaloḥ nipātitāyāṃ, sahyādri-gata-nārāyaṇāṃśa-āmalaka-vṛkṣa-mūla-sambhūtāyāṃ, brahma-kamaṇḍalu-sthita-śaṅkha-ninīta-virajā-tīrtha-saṅgatāyām, sahyāmalaka-tīrtha-śaṅkha-tīrtha-samākhyā-prasiddhāyām, veda-ghoṣa-tulya-śabdena mahāve-

gena śilā-vṛkṣādi-gharṣaṇena ṛju-vakra-maṇḍalādi-anekākāreṇa samudrābhimukhaṃ pravāhitāyāṃ,

5. śiraḥ-sthāna-sthita-dattātreyāyām, aṅka-sthāna-śayita-raṅganāthāyāṃ, śrīvaikuṇṭha-rūpāntara-śrīraṅga-kṣetra-maṇḍitāyāṃ,

6. tulā-māsa-puṇyakāle tulā-puṣkara-puṇyakāle ca sarvalokagata-sārdha-trikoṭi-puṇya-tīrtha-saṅgatāyām, ardhodaya-mahodayādi-kāle ativiśiṣṭa-snānāyām,

7. tūṣṇīṃ-snānena api sapta-janma-pāpa-vināśinyāṃ, niyama-pūrvaka-snānena ubhaya-vaṃśa-sapta-puruṣa-uddhāraṇa-kāriṇyām, aneka-naraka-yātanā-nivṛtti-hetu-bhūtāyāṃ, sākṣāt-snāna-aśaktānām ānayanena, śītala-snāna-aśaktānām uṣṇīkaraṇena api snānena puṇya-dāyām

8. viśvāmitra-bhīṣma-yudhiṣṭhira-arjunādi-mahāpuruṣaiḥ sevitāyāṃ, vedarāśi-nāmakasya tapaḥ-śīlasya viprasya atyanta-puṇyātiśaya-pradānena prasiddhāyām, aśvamedha-yāgaṃ kartum udyuktāya hariścandra-mahārājāya tad-yogyatā-siddhyartham nāradena agastyena ca upadiṣṭa-snānāyām

9. āyur-ārogya-pradāyāṃ, japa-puraścaraṇa-vratādi-siddhi-pradāyām

10. devānām ṛṣīṇāṃ pitṝṇāṃ manuṣyāṇāṃ prāṇināṃ sarva-bhūta-vargāṇāṃ parama-tṛpti-pradāyām

evamādi-bahu-guṇa-viśeṣaṇa-viśiṣṭāyām asyāṃ kāverī-mahānadyām samasta-hari-hara-devatā-gurucaraṇa-śrotriya-sannidhau brahmaṇaḥ dvitīya-parārdhe śvetavarāha-kalpe prathame varṣe prathame māse prathame pakṣe prathame divase ahni dvitīye yāme tṛtīye muhūrte saptame vaivasvata-manvantare aṣṭāviṃśatitame kaliyuge prathame pāde asmin vartamāne vyāvahārikāṇāṃ prabhavādīnāṃ ṣaṣṭyāḥ

vatsarāṇāṃ madhye ___-nāmani vatsare **dakṣiṇāyane śarad**-ṛtau **tulā**-māse **śukla/kṛṣṇa**-pakṣe ___ śubhatithau ___-vāsarayuktāyāṃ ___-nakṣatrayuktāyām ___-yogayuktāyāṃ ___-karaṇayuktāyām tulā-māsa-puṇya-kāle –

1. asmākaṃ sarveṣāṃ mahājanānāṃ kṣema-sthairya-vīrya-vijaya-āyuḥ-ārogya-aiśvaryāṇām abhivṛddhyarthaṃ
2. dharma-artha-kāma-mokṣa-rūpacaturvidha-phala-puruṣārthasiddhyartham, iṣṭa-kāmyārtha-siddhyarthaṃ
3. janānāṃ dharmaika-śraddhā-pravṛtti-ubhaya-siddhyarthaṃ durācāra-nivṛttipūrvaka-sadācāra-sampattyarthaṃ
4. tena ativṛṣṭi-anāvṛṣṭi-rāhityena paryāpta-vṛṣṭyā vāpī-kūpādi-jalāśayānāṃ sampūrtyartham, upanadī-sahitāsu kāverī-tāmraparṇī-pinākinī-tuṅgabhadrā-kṛṣṇā-godāvarī-prabhṛtiṣu samyak-pravāha-siddhyarthaṃ
5. janānāṃ jala-sampadaḥ samyag-viniyoge śraddhāyāḥ udayārthaṃ, parisara-pradūṣaṇa-parihāreṇa pṛthivyāḥ tāpa-śāntyarthaṃ
6. taddvārā deśe'smin sarva-dhānyānām, auṣadhādi-guṇayuktānāṃ sasyānām, chāyā-phalādi-pradānāṃ vṛkṣāṇāṃ ca samṛddhyarthaṃ, gavādīnāṃ bahukṣīrādi-pradatvārtham
7. anena sarveṇa etad-deśa-nivāsināṃ sukha-śānta-jīvana-siddhyartham
8. mama bālyādiṣu jāgṛdādiṣu ca avasthāsu mano-vāk-kāya-karmendriya-jñānendriya-vyāpāraiḥ kāma-krodhādibhiḥ duṣṭa-guṇaiśca sambhāvitānāṃ jñānataḥ sakṛt kṛtānām ajñānataḥ asakṛt kṛtānāṃ rahasyakṛtānāṃ prakāśakṛtānāṃ vā mahāpātaka-samapātaka-upapātakādīnāṃ sarveṣāṃ pāpānāṃ sadyaḥ apanodanārthaṃ

śruti-smṛti-purāṇa-pratipādita-karmānuṣṭhāna-adhikārasiddhyarthaṃ ca

asyāṃ ___ śubhatithau

durbhojana-durālāpa-duṣpratigraha-sambhavam |
pāpaṃ hara mama kṣipraṃ sahyakanye namo'stu te||

sahyapādodbhave devi śrīraṅgotsaṅgagāmini|
śrīkāveri namastubhyaṃ mama pāpaṃ vyapohaya||

ityādinā prārthitāyāṃ bhagavatyāṃ kāveryāṃ snānam anyāni ca yathāśakti pūjādānādīni dharmakāryāṇi kariṣye|| (apa upaspṛśya)

prārthanā

atikrūra mahākāya kalpānta-dahanopama|
bhairavāya namastubhyam anujñāṃ dātumarhasi||

samasta-jagadādhāra śaṅkhacakra-gadādhara|
dehi deva mamānujñāṃ yuṣmattīrtha-niṣevaṇe||

Snana should be done silently by uttering only mantras or Bhagavan Nama. Those who do snana in the river, should face against the flow of the river and those who do snana at other places should face the Sun.

Chanting Veda mantras in the following procedures are to be done by those who have learnt them. Others may chant the Bhagavan Nama of their choice or other stotras in praise of Bhagavan as mantras. Snana should not be done without mantras!

sūktapaṭhanam

Varuna Sukta is to be chanted. Those who do not know may chant at least the Purusha Sukta. This is a prayer to Varuna before bathing.

mārjanam

āpo hi ṣṭhā mayobhuvaḥ ...

Saying the above mantras, one should do prokshanam just as in Sandhya-vandanam.

aghamarṣaṇam

hiraṇyaśṛṅgaṃ varuṇaṃ prapadye ...
The sukta starting as above may be chanted by those who know it. Those who do not know may recite Purusha Sukta here as well. Here one should take at least 12 dips and bathe.

snānāṅga-tarpaṇam

mamopātta+prītyartham adya pūrvokta-viśeṣaṇa-viśiṣṭāyām asyām __ śubhatithau snānāṅga-deva-ṛṣi-pitṛtarpaṇam arghyadānaṃ ca kariṣye||
After doing this Sankalpa, one should do the tarpana as in Brahmayajna.

kāverī-devyai arghyapradānam

marudvṛdhe mahābhāge sarvalokaikapāvani|
gṛhāṇārghyaṃ mayā dattaṃ pāvanaṃ kuru māṃ sadā||1||
kāveryai namaḥ - idamarghyam (3)||

viṣṇumāye mahākāye kaverakulasambhave|
sahyācalasamudbhūte gṛhāṇārghyaṃ varaprade||2||
kāveryai namaḥ - idamarghyam (3)||

kumbhasambhavakumbhāt tvaṃ sahyāmalakapūjayā|
śaṅkhodakena sañjātā gṛhāṇārghyaṃ samudrage||3||
kāveryai namaḥ - idamarghyam (3)||

prārthanā

marudvṛdhe mahālakṣmīssahyakanyā sarasvatī|
agastyapatnī kāverī lopāmudrā varapradā||1||

kamaṇḍalusamutpannā sarvatīrthādhidevatā|
virajā dakṣiṇā gaṅgā brahmaviṣṇuśivātmikā||2||

caturvidhaphaloddhātrī caturānanakanyakā|
sarvābhīṣṭapradātrī ca nāmnāṃ ṣoḍaśakaṃ smṛtam|
ebhirnāmapadairnityaṃ pūjayedbhaktimānnaraḥ||3||

dānam

Then, according to one's capacity, saying the following mantras, offer dakshina to Brahmanas.

hiraṇyagarbha-garbhasthaṃ hemabījaṃ vibhāvasoḥ|
anantapuṇyaphaladam ataḥ śāntiṃ prayaccha me||

anuṣṭhita-tulāsnāna-sādguṇyārthaṃ yathokta-phalaprāptyartham imāṃ dakṣiṇāṃ brāhmaṇāya sampradade| na mama|

yakṣma-tarpaṇam

To nullify the sins caused because we mix the dirt such as sweat from our body into the punya tirthas, recite the following shloka, take water with both hands once and do tarpana to Yakshma devata.

yanmayā dūṣitaṃ toyaṃ śārīramalasañcayāt|
taddoṣaparihārārthaṃ yakṣmāṇaṃ tarpayāmyaham||
yakṣmāṇaṃ tarpayāmi||

samarpaṇam

kāyena vācā manasendriyairvā
buddhyātmanā vā prakṛteḥ svabhāvāt|
karomi yadyat sakalaṃ parasmai
nārāyaṇāyeti samarpayāmi||

anena mayā kṛtena tulāsnānena paramātmā suprītaḥ suprasanno varado bhavatu||

❁❁❁

The Greatness of Kaveri

- Originating in the Kodagu region of the Sahya mountain range (the Western Ghats) in Karnataka, the Kaveri eventually reaches the sea near Poompuhar (Kaveripoompattinam), close to Thiruvenkadu in Tamil Nadu.

- She is a manifestation of the Maya (divine illusion) of Lord Vishnu Himself. She was a daughter of Brahma. Through His grace she was born as the daughter of a king named Kavera. Taking on a human form, she became known as Lopamudra and married the sage Agastya. She also resided in the form of sacred water within the sage's kamandalu.

- Shriman Narayana Himself declared her to be "the Ganga of the South", stating that bathing on the banks of the Kaveri for just one day — compared to three days on the banks of the Ganga or five days on the banks of the Yamuna — is sufficient to cleanse one of all sins accumulated throughout one's life. Lord Parameshwara also blessed her, promising to reside in various sacred sites along both her banks, from her source all the way to the sea.

- At the beginning of the Tamil month of Aippasi, when the Sun enters the Tula Rashi, Lord Ganesha — taking the form of a crow — tipped over the kamandalu of Sage Agastya, allowing the Kaveri to flow forth. She began her course in the Sahya mountains beneath an amla (Indian gooseberry/nelli) tree, which is considered an aspect of Shriman Narayana. At that moment, Brahma poured the Viraja Tirtha — held within his own kamandalu — into her waters using a shankha. Consequently, she came to be known as Sahya Amalaka Tirtha and Shankha Tirtha. With a roar resembling the chanting of the Vedas, and moving with great velocity — sweeping along stones and trees, flowing in straight lines, curves, and circular patterns — she journeyed toward the ocean in a myriad of ways.

- At her source stands the great sage Dattatreya, and Lord Ranganatha resting upon Her lap. Shrirangam — a manifestation of Shri Vaikuntha — in situated on her.

- During the Tula Masa Punya Kala each year when Surya enters the Tula Rashi, and during the 'Tula Pushkaram' that occurs once every twelve

years when Brihaspati enters the Tula Rashi, 3.5 crore sacred waters from across the world converge and unite with her. Bathing in her waters during auspicious times such as Ardhodaya and Mahodaya is considered especially meritorious.

- A simple bath in her waters is sufficient to wash away the sins of seven lifetimes. If one bathes according to the prescribed scriptural injunctions, one can liberate seven generations of ancestors from both the maternal and paternal lineages. She has the power to alleviate the torments of various hells. Even for those unable to come and bathe in her directly, even if bath is done by bringing her water to them — or warming it, if the water is too cold — bestows great spiritual merit.

- She has been revered by great souls such as Vishvamitra, Bhishma, Yudhishthira, and Arjuna. The Puranas recount that she granted a supreme state of liberation to an ascetic named Vedarashi. When King Harishchandra sought to perform the Ashvamedha Yaga, the sages Narada and Agastya advised him to bathe in her waters to attain the necessary eligibility for the ritual.

- In the worldly aspect, she bestows longevity and good health. In the spiritual realm, she bestows the siddhi of japa, purashcharana, vrata-s etc.

- She grants profound satisfaction to all beings — including the deva-s (celestial beings), rishi-s (sages), pitru-s (ancestors), humans, and animals.